

Direction Column	Description
client ⇒ server	command is conveyed from the client to the server cluster
client ⇐ server	command is conveyed from the server to the client cluster

Each command SHALL be described in its own section with a table defining command fields (if any).

7.11.1. Command Fields

A command MAY indicate zero or more fields that are defined in a table. Each command field is defined as a row in the table with these columns:

Column	Description
ID	This is the unique field ID of the field
Name	This is the unique name of the field
Type	This is the data type of the field
Constraint	See Section 7.18.3.3, “Constraint”
Quality	See Section 7.7, “Other Qualities”
Fallback	See Section 7.18.4, “Fallback Column”
Conformance	See Section 7.3, “Conformance”

Command field conformance defines the sender requirements to include the field in a well-formed command for the revision of the cluster. A new command field or a newly made-mandatory command field in a newly revised cluster specification may be omitted by a legacy sender. The cluster specification SHALL define clear behavior upon receipt of any possible well-formed command with fields that are not present. The cluster specification SHALL take into consideration the revision history of possible well-formed commands from legacy implementations. To allow deprecation, it is recommended that command fields have a well-defined default value (such as NULL), and associated default behavior, that is equivalent to omitting the field. Well-defined behavior, for a field that is not present, may be no behavior at all.

For example

A newly revised Noise cluster adds a new mandatory Volume field to the MakeNoise command. Legacy receivers will ignore the Volume field, and legacy senders will not include the field.

Another example

The Volume field is mandatory for the original cluster and there is a proposal to make it optional. The Volume field NULL value has the semantic of ignoring the field, so instead of making it optional, the default value is used. This would make the receiver logic simpler.